

Naan

Yogurt-leavened · thin & pliable · no yeast · restaurant-style

YIELD	ACTIVE	REST	HYDRATION
~8 naan	~35 min	3–6 hr	~68%

INGREDIENTS

stretch to 2–3 mm · cook on a dry pan at 450–500°F

DOUGH

All-purpose flour	440 g
Yogurt full-fat	212 g
Water room temp	90 g
Neutral oil	30 g
Sugar	12 g
Salt	6 g
Baking powder	4 g

FINISH

Butter or ghee melted, for brushing	120 g
Cilantro chopped	optional
Garlic minced, into the butter	optional
Nigella seeds	optional

Double batch — ~8 naan at ~100 g balls (single batch = 4). **Single:** halve everything. **Want ~12?** ×1.5 this batch.

Why no yeast: yeast makes thick, bready naan. **Yogurt + baking powder** gives the thin, pliable texture with just enough lift for bubbles. **Hand-stretch, never roll** — rolling compresses the dough into a tough result; passing the ball between oiled palms and letting gravity do the work keeps it tender. **Rest is flavor + workability:** 3 hr minimum, 6 hr better; overnight in the fridge works (pull 1 hr before cooking).

Mix, Stretch & Char

METHOD

screaming-hot dry cast iron, lid on first side, broiler char to finish

- 1 **Dry:** whisk flour, baking powder, sugar, salt in a large bowl.
- 2 **Wet:** add yogurt, water, oil; mix with a spatula to a shaggy mass.
- 3 **Knead:** 5–7 min to a soft, **tacky** dough (tackier at this hydration) — wet or oiled hands, **don't add flour**. The extra water is what keeps it soft as it cools.
- 4 **Rest:** oiled bowl, covered, 3–6 hr at room temp (overnight in the fridge is fine).
- 5 **Divide:** turn out onto a lightly oiled surface, divide into ~8 balls (~100 g).
- 6 **Stretch:** oil your hands, press flat and hand-stretch by passing between palms to 2–3 mm, ~6–7". Don't roll.
- 7 **Heat:** cast iron screaming hot, no oil — IR 450–500°F. Have a lid ready; preheat the broiler on high.
- 8 **Cook:** lay the naan in the dry pan and immediately cover. 60–90 sec until bubbles form and the bottom has dark spots.
- 9 **Flip:** uncovered 60–90 sec; press the edges with a spatula if needed.
- 10 **Char:** transfer to a sheet, under the broiler 2–4" from the element — watch closely, 10–20 sec for char.
- 11 **Finish:** brush immediately with melted butter/ghee; stack in a towel-lined container to keep warm.

TROUBLESHOOTING

garlic naan: stir minced garlic into the finishing butter

PROBLEM	CAUSE	FIX
Tough / chewy	Over-kneaded or rolled	Hand-stretch only; knead 7 min max
No bubbles	Pan not hot enough, or dough too dry	Hotter pan (450°F+); add water 5 ml at a time
Tears when stretching	Under-rested or over-kneaded	Rest longer (3 hr min); let it relax 10 min
Toughens as it cools	Under-hydrated — crumb dries and firms (staling)	More water — hydration is the lever. Serve warm, wrap in a towel to hold softness.